

MENTABLE

Talent is everywhere. Access isn't.

Mentable connects people with those who have already walked the path ahead of them, and gives the relationship structure after the introduction.

THE RESOURCE ALREADY EXISTS

Universities are sitting on the thing students need most.

Alumni who would genuinely take the call. Students who would act on it. A shared institution that makes the first message easy to send.

Most of those relationships still never happen.

THE PROBLEM ISN'T GOODWILL

Five places it breaks.

Finding

A student cannot tell who would say yes, so they ask nobody.

Asking

The first message is the hardest one, and most are never sent.

Purpose

A friendly chat with no question wastes an hour of goodwill.

Following through

Advice given in October is forgotten by November without a record.

Knowing

Nobody can say whether the program produced a single conversation.

WHAT MENTABLE DOES

Infrastructure around the relationship.

Activate

Invite both sides into one place.

Match

Pair on need and on where someone can really help.

Structure

Goals, conversations and a shared record.

Accountability

Every conversation ends with a next step.

Measure

Participation and momentum, not surveillance.

The relationship still belongs to the two people in it. Mentable holds everything around it.

FOR THE STUDENT

What changes when someone a few steps ahead helps.

- **Clarity** — what the path actually looks like, not what it looks like from outside
- **Preparation** — doing the work already knowing what the work is
- **Context** — the timeline, the unwritten parts, the mistakes that cost a year
- **Accountability** — someone expecting them to have done the thing
- **Access** — one real relationship where there were none

Mentable does not promise internships, interviews or offers, and no part of the product claims to. It changes how quickly ability turns into informed action.

FOR THE ALUM

Giving back, made specific.

- Who am I helping, and why me?
- What do they actually need?
- Have they prepared?
- What happened after we spoke?

The alternative

An open inbox, cold requests from strangers, no context, no sense of whether any of it mattered. Most alumni say yes once and are never asked well again.

Mentors say what they can help someone navigate. Requests arrive with context. Nobody is asked to be a careers service.

FOR THE INSTITUTION

One layer. Many communities.

Organization



Programs



Cohorts



Mentorships

Alumni and students

The general case, across any school or class year.

Family business

A specific community with a specific question.

First generation

Students without inherited professional context.

Each program has its own participants and its own lead. A program lead administers their program and nothing else.

THE CAROLINA OPPORTUNITY

Few places have this much willingness to give back.

Carolina's alumni identity is unusually strong, and that is the scarce input. The software is the easy part; a community that actually answers is not.

The question is whether that willingness can be turned into relationships reliably enough to count on.

Mentable has no agreement with UNC-Chapel Hill. This is a conversation about whether it is worth exploring one.

HOW A PILOT COULD WORK

Start small enough to learn something.

Recruit

A handful of alumni who say yes.

Invite

Students into one named program.

Match

By hand, because the numbers allow it.

Run

One semester of real relationships.

Learn

What worked, what stalled, what to change.

Mentable's own first cohort is ten students and ten mentors over one semester, for exactly this reason. Scale is the second problem.

WHAT A PROGRAM LEAD CAN SEE

Enough to run it. Not enough to intrude on it.

VISIBLE

Participants, mentors, mentees	●
Matches made, still waiting	●
Conversations held and upcoming	●
Goals and next steps completed	●
Relationships quiet 30+ days	●

No engagement scores, no rankings, no leaderboards. Counts of things that did or did not happen.

Never visible

Messages between a mentor and a student. Not as a setting that is switched off, but as something the software does not provide. Administrators have no database access to message content at all.

RETURN ON IMPACT

It doesn't end with you.



One opportunity doesn't have to stop with one person. Someone shares what they know, a student carries it forward, and eventually becomes the person someone else needed.

Illustrative. This is the model Mentable is built to enable, not a measured result. Mentable is early and has no completed cycle to report.

THE CONVERSATION

What would it take to make mentorship part of the Carolina experience?

Who first?

Which community would benefit most, and is small enough to start with?

What is success?

What would make this obviously worth continuing a year from now?

What must a pilot prove?

What would we need to see before anyone commits further?